In: Combating Islamic Militancy and Terrorism…
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Chapter 4

COMBATING TERRORISM: INCREASED OVERSIGHT AND ACCOUNTABILITY NEEDED OVER PAKISTAN REIMBURSEMENT CLAIMS FOR COALITION SUPPORT FUNDS *

United States Government Accountability Office

WHY GAO DID THIS STUDY

The United States has reimbursed Pakistan, a key ally in the global war on terror, about $5.56 billion in Coalition Support Funds (CSF) for its efforts to combat terrorism along its border with Afghanistan. The Department of Defense (Defense) provides CSF to 27 coalition partners for costs incurred in direct support of U.S. military operations. Pakistan is the largest recipient of CSF, receiving 81 percent of CSF reimbursements as of May 2008.

This report focuses on (1) the extent to which Defense has consistently applied its guidance to validate the reimbursements claimed by Pakistan and (2) how the Office of the Defense Representative to Pakistan's (ODRP) role has changed over time. To address these objectives, GAO reviewed CSF oversight procedures, examined CSF documents, and interviewed Defense officials in Washington, D.C., U.S. Central Command in Florida, and Pakistan.

WHAT GAO RECOMMENDS

GAO recommends that Defense consistently implement existing oversight criteria, formalize ODRP's oversight responsibilities, and implement additional controls. Defense generally concurred with the recommendations but stated that the report lacked sufficient

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* This is an edited, reformatted and augmented version of a U. S. Government Accountability Office publication dated June 2008.

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